That wasn't good enough. I'd been falling down on my job, as an opener, to score big runs to set up wins.

'If I don't start scoring runs I will be dropped,' I told the room. 'I don't care what anyone else is doing, but I'm not doing my job for the team. I'm putting pressure on number three, four and five. I need to buck my ideas up and deliver the goods. Everything is in place for it, but it is down to me to bat, to front up, to stand up. We can talk all we like about achieving, blah, blah, blah, but if I do that, we'll all be better off.'

Andy, who was chairing the meeting, seized the moment. He said it was the first time anyone in the group had admitted to vulnerability and put their contribution into a team context. That sort of honesty, he insisted, was essential if trust was to be restored, and talent was to be explored. Change is only possible when people are prepared to admit the need to change.

We left the room, after several hours, with a determination to draw a line under a difficult period during which Kevin Pietersen and Peter Moores had been sacked as captain and coach, respectively. We had been all over the place. There had been too many excuses, too much distraction. We needed to be more honest in our assessment of where we were, and what we did.

Our skill levels needed to improve. We had been too casual in our debriefing. The remnants of a drinking culture needed to be tackled. There had been too much blame and bullshit. Our fitness levels and mental durability were not good enough. Our decision-making under pressure was flawed. Were we tough enough? That's not macho posturing, but an essential asset when you are building a long innings or remaining sharp for hours on end in the field in 40-degree heat.

Our training became more physical; instead of the sanitized setting of the gym, we did weight sessions on the outfield. We started boxing, using pads. We consciously challenged ourselves. Were our minds truly open? Successful teams have greater willingness to share experience proactively and to think positively.

The farce of the second Test in Antigua, abandoned after ten deliveries because the outfield resembled a cross between quicksand and one of the island's 365 beaches, provided almost light relief, and marked a turning point of sorts. I proved something to myself by scoring an unbeaten 139 and 94 on a very flat pitch in Bridgetown, and the West Indies showed admirable resilience in saving two Tests with one and two wickets in hand.